**Skill** – Insight (Wisdom) · SRD 5.2.1

**Insight** is used to **read a creature's intentions**: lies, mood, body language. It uses a **Wisdom (Insight)** check, often via the **Search** action.

Against a lie it's a **contested check** with the liar's Deception.

## 🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Wisdom (Insight)** check.
2. Against a liar: contested with their **Deception**.
3. It reveals an impression, not certainty.
4. Passive Insight possible.

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## ⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the skill and ties it to the Search action.

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## ⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say if a success reveals truth or only doubt. Fix: give an impression ("he's hiding something").

## 💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a subtle sign (shifty eyes, tense voice) without saying "he's lying".

## Step 1 – Announce:

The player says they study the creature (or question it).

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## Step 2 – Choose:

Active check or passive Insight for watchfulness.

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## Step 3 – Set the DC:

Against a lie: the opponent's Deception. Otherwise DC 15 by default.

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## Step 4 – Roll:

1d20 + Wisdom + proficiency.

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## Step 5 – Reveal:

Success: a reliable impression; failure: nothing sure.

*Example: Brann doubts the merchant. Insight 15 against his Deception 12: he senses the true price is hidden.*

## ⚠ Common questions:

### Does it detect lies?

It gives an impression, not proof.

### Against a liar?

Contested with their Deception.

### Must I talk?

No: observing is enough.

### Passive Insight?

10 + Wisdom + proficiency.

### Magic?

It doesn't bypass magic (Detect Thoughts).

### Can I retry?

Only if the situation changes.

## ⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

### Absolute truth

Does success reveal the lie? **Option**: an impression only.

### Retrying

Retry on the same person. **Option**: Disadvantage.

### Unknown creature

Reading a foreign species. **Option**: Disadvantage.

## ⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

### Contest

Both roll; the higher wins.

### Impression

Success gives an impression, not certainty.

### Passive

Passive Insight serves continuous watchfulness.

*These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.*

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